

14. Terms & Conditions

By registering for and participating in the SURAKSHA Investor Resilience Hackathon (the "Hackathon"), each participant and participating team (the "Participant") accepts and agrees to be bound by the following terms:

14.1 Intellectual Property. All right, title, and interest in and to any and all ideas, concepts, problem approaches, designs, specifications, architectures, source code, documentation, presentations, demonstrations, and any other materials, whether tangible or intangible, conceived, created, developed, or submitted by the Participant in connection with the Hackathon (collectively, the "Submission") shall vest solely, exclusively, and irrevocably in National Securities Depository Limited ("NSDL") upon submission. The Participant hereby irrevocably assigns, transfers, and conveys to NSDL, on a worldwide, perpetual, royalty-free basis, all intellectual property rights of whatever nature subsisting in the Submission, including without limitation all copyrights, patent rights, design rights, trade secret rights, and all other proprietary rights, together with the right to seek and obtain registration thereof in NSDL's own name.

14.2 Right of Use. NSDL shall be entitled, at its sole and absolute discretion, to use, reproduce, adapt, modify, translate, publish, distribute, commercialise, sub-licence, or otherwise exploit the Submission, in whole or in part, in any medium and for any purpose, without the requirement of obtaining any further express consent from, providing any intimation or notice to, or making any payment, royalty, or further consideration to the Participant.

14.3 Waiver of Claims. The Participant irrevocably waives any and all moral rights, rights of attribution, and rights of objection in respect of the Submission to the fullest extent permitted under applicable law, and shall not assert any claim against NSDL, the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), the Club of ProgrammerS, IIT (BHU) Varanasi, or any of their respective officers, employees, agents, or affiliates in respect of any use of the Submission.

14.4 Warranty of Originality. The Participant represents and warrants that the Submission is original to the Participant, does not infringe or misappropriate the intellectual property rights or other rights of any third party, and is free of any encumbrance, licence, or obligation that would restrict the rights granted under Clause 14.1. The Participant shall indemnify and hold harmless NSDL and SEBI against any loss, claim, damage, or expense arising from any breach of this warranty. Where the Submission incorporates any third-party or open-source component, the Participant shall disclose such component and the licence governing it at the time of submission.

14.5 Confidentiality and Disclosure. The Participant acknowledges that Submissions may be reviewed, retained, and internally circulated by NSDL and SEBI, and that NSDL is under no obligation of confidentiality in respect of any Submission unless expressly agreed in writing.

14.6 Compliance and Disqualification. The Participant shall comply with the Mandatory Guardrails set out in Section 4 and with all applicable laws, regulations, and directions issued by SEBI. The organisers reserve the right, at their sole discretion, to disqualify any Participant or Submission that violates these terms, and to withhold or revoke any award or recognition accordingly.

14.7 Amendment and Governing Law. The organisers reserve the right to amend, modify, suspend, or withdraw any aspect of the Hackathon, including these terms, the timeline, and the evaluation criteria, at any time. These terms shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of India, and the courts at Mumbai shall have exclusive jurisdiction over any dispute arising hereunder.

(Legal language to be vetted and finalised by NSDL's legal team before publication.)